

FREE GUIDE

THE 25 BOOKS THAT SHAPED HOW I BUILD

The books I've found most helpful building businesses from zero, and why each one earned a place on the list.

Fa'res Hussein

fareshusseini.com

This guide contains Amazon affiliate links. If you buy through them I may earn a small commission, at no extra cost to you. I only list books I've actually read and found genuinely useful.

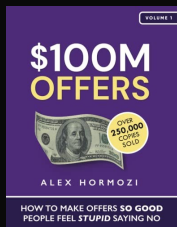
BEFORE YOU START

A NOTE ON HOW I READ

I read a mix of eBooks and physical books. But because my [Kobo Libra Colour](#) can carry far more books than I can practically carry or neatly store (I move around a lot), I lean toward reading on the Kobo more often than not.

Tap any title in this guide to see the book on Amazon.

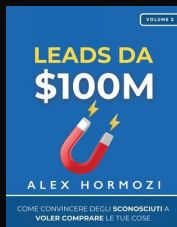
BUSINESS & STRATEGY



01 \$100M Offers

Alex Hormozi

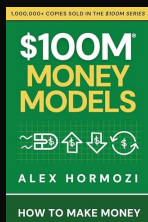
The clearest thing I've read on building an offer so good people feel silly saying no. It reframed how I price and package everything.



02 \$100M Leads

Alex Hormozi

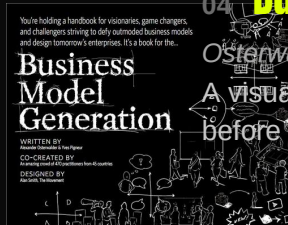
The follow-up on actually getting people to your offer. Tactical lead-gen you can put to work the same day.



03 \$100M Money Models

Alex Hormozi

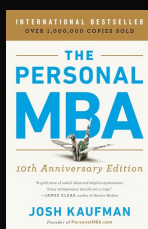
How to structure offers and payments so growth funds itself. Great for thinking past a single sale.



04 Business Model Generation

Osterwalder & Pigneur

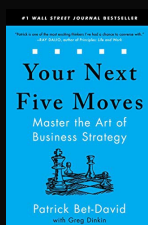
A visual way to map any business on a single page. I use the canvas to pressure-test ideas before committing.



05 The Personal MBA

Josh Kaufman

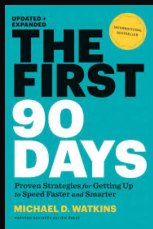
A broad, no-fluff foundation across sales, marketing, finance, and ops. The closest thing to a business degree you can read on your own.



06 Your Next Five Moves

Patrick Bet-David

Thinking several moves ahead like a chess player. Useful for strategy when everything feels urgent at once.

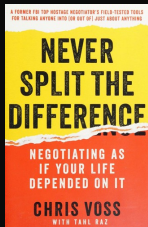


07 **The First 90 Days**

Michael D. Watkins

How to step into any new role or venture and build momentum fast. Handy any time you're starting something.

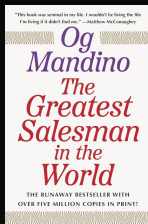
SALES & PERSUASION



08 **Never Split the Difference**

Chris Voss

Negotiation from an FBI hostage negotiator. It changed how I handle every important conversation, not just deals.

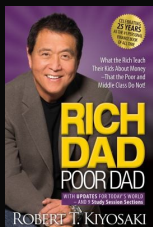


09 **The Greatest Salesman in the World**

Og Mandino

A short parable on discipline and persistence. More about who you become than about tactics.

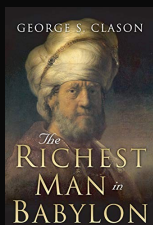
MONEY & WEALTH



10 **Rich Dad Poor Dad**

Robert T. Kiyosaki

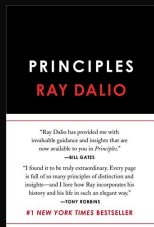
The book that rewired how I think about assets, income, and making money work for you instead of the other way around.



11 **The Richest Man in Babylon**

George S. Clason

Timeless money principles told as ancient parables. Simple rules that still hold up.



12 Principles

Ray Dalio

Dalio's system for making decisions and learning from mistakes. I borrowed a lot from his habit of writing down what works.

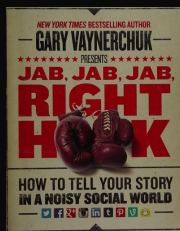
MARKETING & PERSONAL BRAND



13 Crushing It!

Gary Vaynerchuk

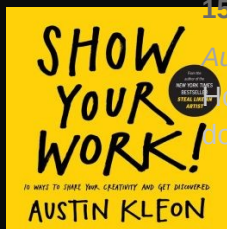
The case for building a personal brand and showing up on the platforms. A big part of why I started putting myself out there.



14 Jab, Jab, Jab, Right Hook

Gary Vaynerchuk

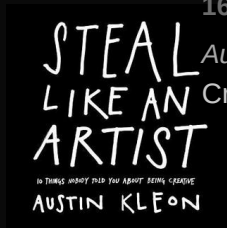
Give value, give value, give value, then ask. The clearest framework I've found for content that actually converts.



15 Show Your Work!

Austin Kleon

How to build an audience by sharing the process, not just the polished result. Permission to document as you go.

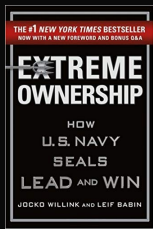


16 Steal Like an Artist

Austin Kleon

Creativity as remixing what you love. A quick, freeing read for when you're afraid to start.

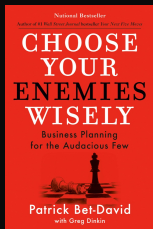
LEADERSHIP & MINDSET



17 Extreme Ownership

Willink & Babin

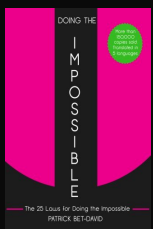
Leadership through total accountability. It's the mindset I try to bring to every problem in my businesses.



18 Choose Your Enemies Wisely

Patrick Bet-David

On building a real business plan and knowing what you're up against. A strong companion to Your Next Five Moves.

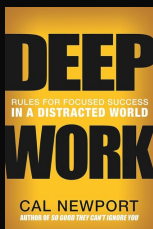


19 Doing the Impossible

Patrick Bet-David

The story behind building a company from nothing. Motivating when the odds feel long.

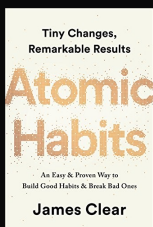
PRODUCTIVITY & PERFORMANCE



20 Deep Work

Cal Newport

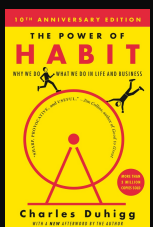
The argument for focus as a superpower. It's why I guard blocks of uninterrupted time.



21 Atomic Habits

James Clear

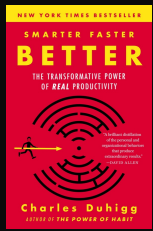
Small habits, repeated, become who you are. The most practical book I've read on actually changing behavior.



22 The Power of Habit

Charles Duhigg

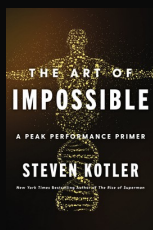
Why habits work the way they do. Pairs well with Atomic Habits for the 'why' behind the 'how.'



23 **Smarter Faster Better**

Charles Duhigg

The science of productivity and motivation, with frameworks for getting more out of the same hours.



24 **The Art of Impossible**

Steven Kotler

A playbook for peak performance and flow. One of my favorites for doing hard things consistently.



25 **The Motivation Hacker**

Nick Winter

A short, fun read on engineering your own motivation. Punchy and immediately useful.